

# System Admin with IT Service Management and AI Emphasis ServiceNow

| Document Information | Details                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
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| Document Title       | Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer                                       |
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## Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

### Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

### User Story:

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

## **Project Objective:**

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

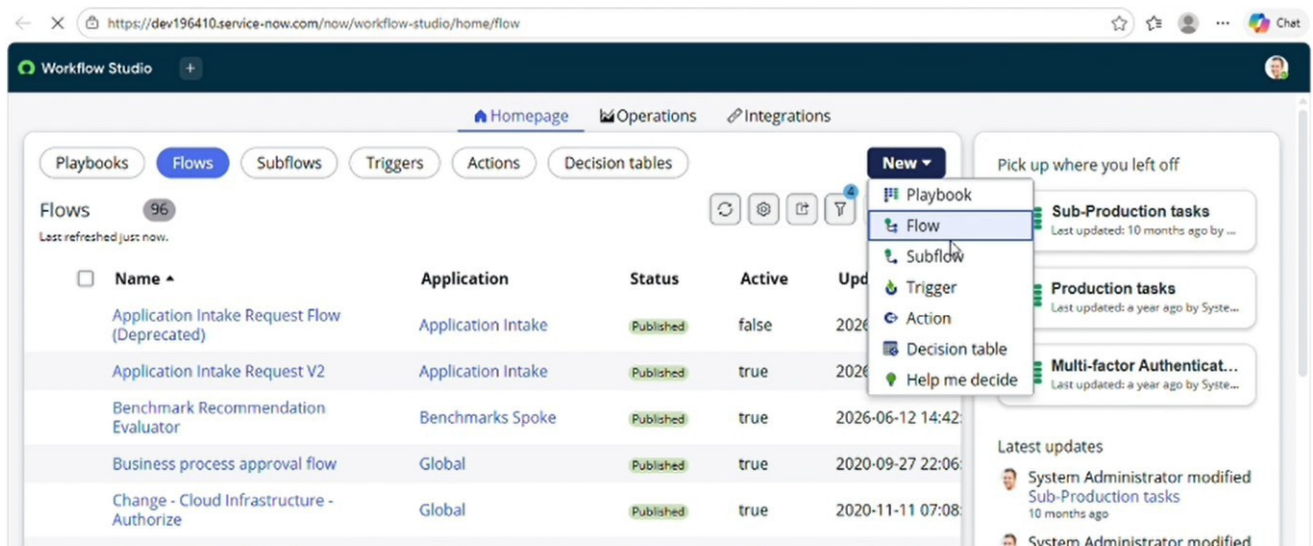
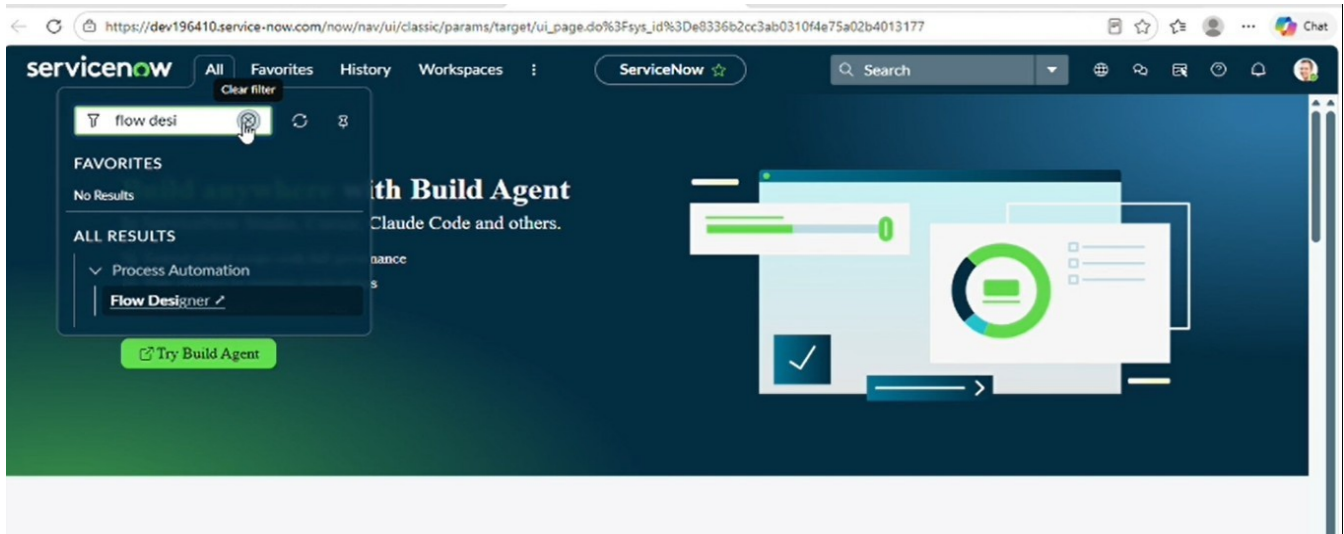
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

## **TASK INITIATION**

### **Milestone 1 : Flow**

**Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.**

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.



## Let's get the details for your flow

Flow name \* ⓘ

Standard laptop task

Application \* ⓘ

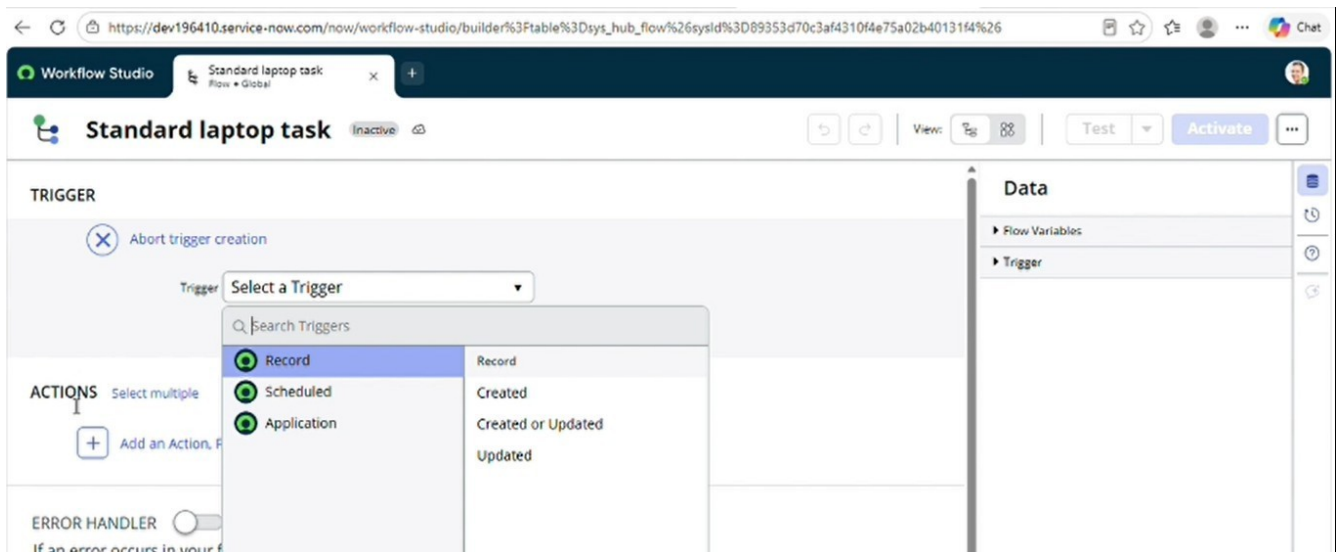
Global

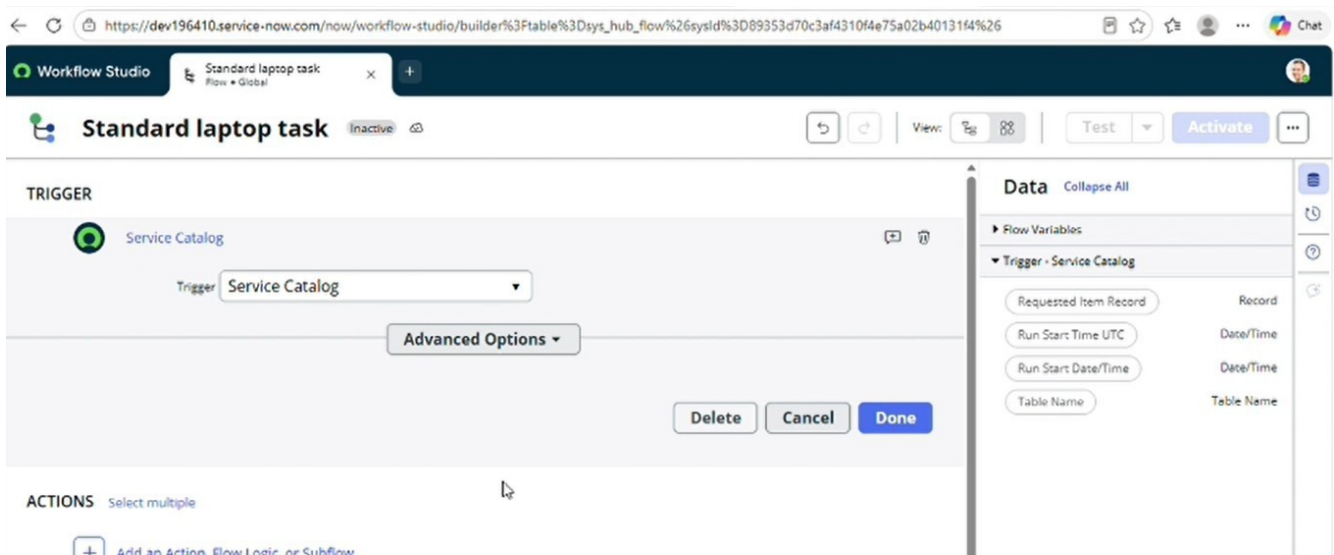
Description ⓘ

Describe your flow.

> Show additional properties

9. Click on Add a trigger
10. Select the trigger in that Search for “ Service Catalog ” and select that.
11. After that click on Done.





12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.

25. Click on save the Flow.

26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.

The screenshot shows the 'Standard laptop task' flow in ServiceNow Workflow Studio. The flow is currently 'Inactive'. The 'Action inputs' section is configured with the following values:

- Table Name: Catalog Task [sc\_task]
- \* Requested Item [Requested Item]: Trigger ~> Requested Item ...
- Short Description: Laptop need to Configured
- Description: Laptop need to Configured
- Assignment group: Hardware
- Fields: Approval (Approved)
- Wait: ☒

The 'Data' panel on the right shows the flow variables for the 'Trigger - Service Catalog' event, including 'Requested Item Record', 'Run Start Time UTC', 'Run Start Date/Time', and 'Table Name'. Below this, the '1 - Create Catalog Task' action is listed with its own variables: 'Catalog Task' (Record) and 'Action Status' (Object).

The screenshot shows the same 'Standard laptop task' flow, but now a confirmation dialog is displayed in the center of the screen. The dialog asks: 'Are you sure you want to activate the flow?' and provides the following information:

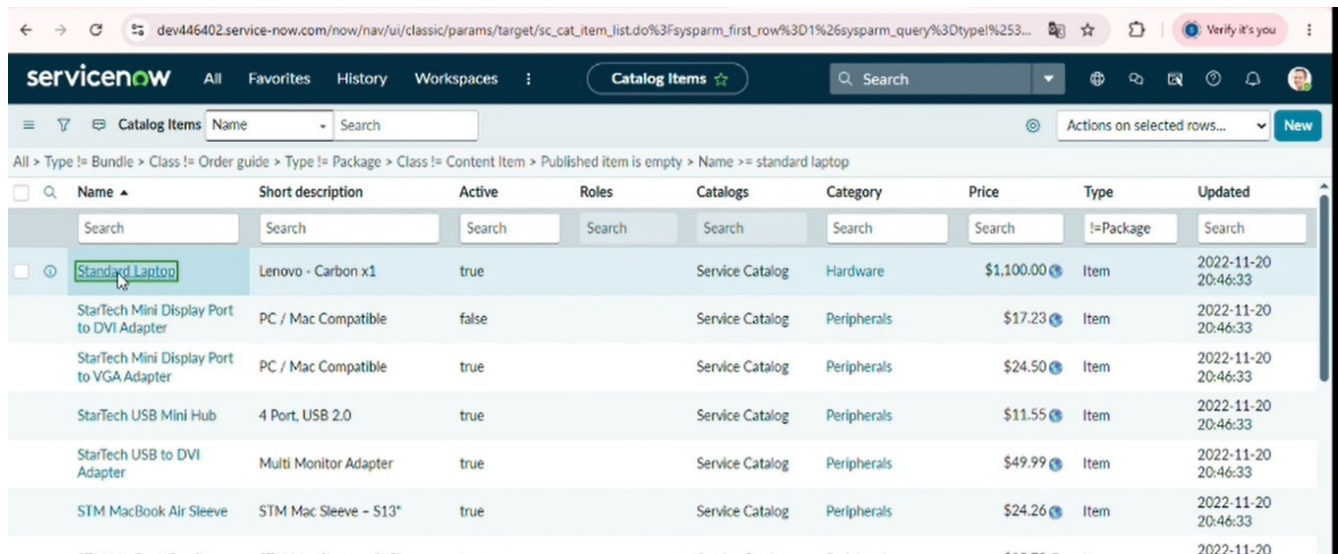
- Your flow will start running when the trigger conditions are met.
- ☐ Don't show me this again
- Buttons: Cancel, Activate

The background interface shows the 'TRIGGER' section set to 'Service Catalog' and the 'ACTIONS' section with '1 - Create Catalog Task'. Below the dialog, the 'ACTIONS' section is expanded, showing a list of installed spokes: 'ServiceNow Core' (selected), 'ITSM', and 'IntegrationHub'. The 'Create Catalog Task' action is highlighted under the 'ServiceNow Core' spoke.

## Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

### Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.



|                          | Name                                      | Short description                   | Active                              | Roles                               | Catalogs                            | Category                            | Price                               | Type                                   | Updated                             |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="text" value="Search"/>       | <input type="text" value="Search"/> | <input type="text" value="Search"/> | <input type="text" value="Search"/> | <input type="text" value="Search"/> | <input type="text" value="Search"/> | <input type="text" value="Search"/> | <input type="text" value="!=Package"/> | <input type="text" value="Search"/> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Standard Laptop                           | Lenovo - Carbon x1                  | true                                |                                     | Service Catalog                     | Hardware                            | \$1,100.00                          | Item                                   | 2022-11-20 20:46:33                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | StarTech Mini Display Port to DVI Adapter | PC / Mac Compatible                 | false                               |                                     | Service Catalog                     | Peripherals                         | \$17.23                             | Item                                   | 2022-11-20 20:46:33                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | StarTech Mini Display Port to VGA Adapter | PC / Mac Compatible                 | true                                |                                     | Service Catalog                     | Peripherals                         | \$24.50                             | Item                                   | 2022-11-20 20:46:33                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | StarTech USB Mini Hub                     | 4 Port, USB 2.0                     | true                                |                                     | Service Catalog                     | Peripherals                         | \$11.55                             | Item                                   | 2022-11-20 20:46:33                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | StarTech USB to DVI Adapter               | Multi Monitor Adapter               | true                                |                                     | Service Catalog                     | Peripherals                         | \$49.99                             | Item                                   | 2022-11-20 20:46:33                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | STM MacBook Air Sleeve                    | STM Mac Sleeve - S13"               | true                                |                                     | Service Catalog                     | Peripherals                         | \$24.26                             | Item                                   | 2022-11-20 20:46:33                 |

The screenshot shows the 'Catalog Item' form for a 'Standard Laptop'. The form is divided into two main sections. The left section contains fields for 'Name' (Standard Laptop), 'Catalogs' (Service Catalog), 'Category' (Hardware), 'State' (None), 'Checked out' (None), 'Owner', and 'Secondary owners'. The right section contains fields for 'Application' (Global), 'Active' (checked), 'Roles', and 'Fulfillment automation level' (Unspecified). At the bottom, there are tabs for 'Item Details', 'Process Engine', 'Picture', 'Pricing', and 'Portal Settings'.

## Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

### Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.

The screenshot shows the 'Standard Laptop' item view in the Service Catalog. The breadcrumb trail is 'Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop'. The item details for 'Lenovo - Carbon x1' are displayed, including a description and technical specifications. On the right side, there is an 'Order this Item' section with a price of \$1,100.00 + \$100.00 Annually, a quantity of 1, a subtotal of \$1,100.00 + \$100.00 Annually, and a delivery time of 9 Days. Below this, there is an 'Order Now' button and an 'Add to Cart' button. At the bottom right, there is a 'Shopping Cart' section showing 'Empty'.

5. Now we will see the Order status

6. In that click on the Request Number

Order Status

Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed: 2026-09-22 23:25:03  
Request Number: [REQ0010002](#) ☆  
Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2026-10-01

| Description (Includes Annual Charges) | Delivery Date | Stage       | Price (ea.)                      | Quantity | Total                            |
|---------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|----------------------------------|----------|----------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Lenovo - Carbon x1</a>    | 2026-10-01    | ▶ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ | \$1,100.00<br>+\$100.00 Annually | 1        | \$1,100.00<br>+\$100.00 Annually |
|                                       |               |             |                                  | Total    | \$1,100.00<br>+\$100.00 Annually |

Back to Catalog Continue Shopping Home

7. It will open the Requested number record.

8. Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

Request - REQ0010001

Short description

Special instructions

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links

Show Workflow Workflow Context

Requested Items (1) Approvers (1) Recurring Prices (1)

Approval for = REQ0010001

| State     | Approver       | Comments | Created             |
|-----------|----------------|----------|---------------------|
| Requested | Eric Schroeder |          | 2024-04-17 04:07:12 |

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links

Show Workflow Workflow Context

Requested Items (1) Approvers (1) Recurring Prices (1)

Approval for = REQ0010001

| State     | Approver       | Comments | Created             |
|-----------|----------------|----------|---------------------|
| Requested | Eric Schroeder |          | 2024-04-17 04:07:12 |

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record

Update Delete

Related Links

Flow Context

Catalog Tasks (1) Approvers Group approvals

Request item = RITM0010001

| Number        | Assignment group | Assigned to | Short description          | Actual start        | Actual end | Order |
|---------------|------------------|-------------|----------------------------|---------------------|------------|-------|
| SCTASK0010001 | Hardware         | (empty)     | Laptop needs to Configured | 2024-04-17 04:11:40 | (empty)    |       |

12. Scroll down to the “ Catalog tasks ” Section

13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

The screenshot shows a ServiceNow Catalog Task form for SCTASK0010001. The form is titled "Catalog Task - SCTASK0010001" and includes a search bar and navigation links. The form fields are as follows:

| Field                       | Value                               |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Number                      | SCTASK0010001                       |
| Assigned to                 |                                     |
| Configuration Item          |                                     |
| Active                      | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| Approval                    | Not Yet Requested                   |
| Priority                    | -- None --                          |
| State                       | Open                                |
| Request Item                | RITM0010002                         |
| Requested for               | System Administrator                |
| Short description           | Laptop need to Configured           |
| Description                 | Laptop need to Configured           |
| Comments (Customer visible) | Comments (Customer visible)         |

The Description field is highlighted with a green border. The form also includes a "Work notes" section at the bottom right.

## Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.